Fixing a CV: the 5 mistakes I found

GoMyCode checkpoint · Career Strategies and Soft Skills · CV of “Keith Shannons”, Software Engineer · by Chimaroke Amadi

The CV looks nice at first: clean colours, clear sections, one page. But when I read it like a recruiter who has 10 seconds, I found 5 problems that would hurt Keith's chances. For each one I explain what is wrong, why it matters, and how I fixed it, with the text before and after. My corrected version is in **Keith-Shannons-CV-corrected.pdf**.

The original CV doesn't give the real numbers behind Keith's work, so the numbers in my version (95%, 12 projects, 25%…) are examples of the kind of figures he should write. On his real CV he would use his own real numbers. The 80% was already in the original.

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1 Vague achievements with no numbers

Two of the three main bullet points use words like *“so many”* and *“a high rate”*. They don't tell the recruiter anything, because anyone can write them. The internship bullets are even weaker: *“Learned about the operations…”* describes what Keith was taught, not what he did. A good bullet shows a **result**, ideally with a number: *what I did, how, and what it changed*.

BEFORE

“Maintained so many customer satisfaction rating by developing and implementing software solutions based on client requirements”

“Boosted team efficiency by a high rate…”

“Learned about the operations of the company's software programming team”

AFTER

“Kept customer satisfaction above 95% across 12 client projects by designing and building software from each client's requirements.”

“Increased the team's delivery speed by 25% by leading code reviews and setting the technical direction for 3 business applications in development.”

“Built and tested 4 features for an internal tool with the programming team, using Git, pull requests and code reviews.”

I also moved the strongest bullet (HR processes 80% faster) to the top, because recruiters read the first line the most.

2 Grammar mistakes and things that aren't consistent

Small errors make a CV look rushed, and for a software engineer, attention to detail is part of the job. I found:

- *“Maintained so many customer satisfaction rating”*: it should be plural (“ratings”), and the sentence doesn't really make sense. You don't “maintain many ratings”.
- *“Javascript”* should be written **JavaScript**. Recruiters and ATS (the software that reads CVs) look for the exact name.
- The dates use two styles: *“March 2022 to August 2025”* and *“Oct 2021 to Dec 2021”*. The extra durations “(3 years, 5 months)” take space and don't add much.
- Labels like *“Institution:”* and *“Year of Graduation:”* are only used in the education part, while the jobs don't have labels.

BEFORE

Javascript · March 2022 to August 2025 (3 years, 5 months) · Oct 2021 to Dec 2021 (3 months) · Institution: De Loureigh University · Year of Graduation: 2021

AFTER

JavaScript · Mar 2022 – Aug 2025 · Oct 2021 – Dec 2021 · De Loureigh University · Graduated 2021

One date style, placed on the right of every title.

3 A broken LinkedIn link and weak contact details

The LinkedIn address *“linkedin.com/in/Keith Shannons”* has a **space** and capital letters. A web address can't have a space, so if a recruiter clicks it or types it, it won't work. The email starts with “hello@”, which looks like a general company inbox, not a person. There's also no city, so the recruiter doesn't know if Keith is local or open to remote work.

BEFORE

linkedin.com/in/Keith Shannons
hello@reallygreatsite.com
(no location)

AFTER

linkedin.com/in/keith-shannons
keith.shannons@reallygreatsite.com
Roseton · open to remote

I grouped all the contact details in one “Contact” block with small labels, so they are easy to find.

4 No professional summary

The CV jumps straight from the name to the job list. A recruiter has to read everything to understand who Keith is and what job he wants. A short summary of 2–3 sentences at the top answers three questions: **who I am, what I'm good at (with one proof), and what I'm looking for**.

BEFORE

Keith Shannons
Software Engineer
(then directly “Work Experience”)

AFTER

“Software engineer with 3+ years of experience building cloud-based business applications with JavaScript, Python and Java. I turn client requirements into reliable software and look for ways to remove manual work, like an HR system that made HR processes 80% faster. Looking for a software engineer role where I can own features from design to deployment.”

5 A skills section that is too thin

“Relevant skills” is only one line of 6 programming languages. It doesn't show any frameworks, databases, cloud or tools, but the job bullets talk about a *cloud-based system* and *databases and servers*. Many companies filter CVs with ATS keywords like “React”, “SQL”, “AWS” or “Git”, so this CV could be rejected before a person even reads it. There are also no soft skills, even though Keith coordinated departments and gave direction to a team.

BEFORE

Javascript, C/C++, Java, Python, Kotlin, Go

AFTER

Languages: JavaScript, Python, Java, Go, Kotlin, C/C++
Frameworks: Node.js, Express, React, Spring Boot
Data & cloud: SQL (PostgreSQL), MongoDB, AWS, Docker
Ways of working: Git, REST APIs, code reviews, Agile/Scrum
Soft skills: clear communication across teams, mentoring, problem solving

Smaller things I also changed

- **The photo:** I removed it. In many countries recruiters prefer CVs without photos (to avoid bias), and ATS software can't read them. It also took the space where the summary now is.
- **The layout:** in the original, the right column is almost empty under the skills while the left column is crowded. I balanced the two columns and gave the side column a light background so it reads as “quick facts”.
- **Decorative icons** (the atom and the book) took space without adding information, so I removed them.
- The job title **“Intern”** became **“Software Engineering Intern”**, and the job titles are no longer in capitals, which are harder to read.

Before and after



Keith Shannons

Software Engineer

linkedin.com/in/Keith Shannons

hello@reallygreatsite.com
+123-456-7890
www.reallygreatsite.com

WORK EXPERIENCE

JUNIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER
Heiman Software Labs, a global company that provides software services across various industries
March 2022 to August 2025
(3 years, 5 months)

- Maintained so many customer satisfaction rating by developing and implementing software solutions based on client requirements
- Boosted team efficiency by a high rate, by providing direction for business applications that are in development
- Hastened human resources processes by 80% by developing a cloud-based information system that consolidated employee information from various databases and servers.

INTERN
Heiman Software Labs
Oct 2021 to Dec 2021 (3 months)

- Learned about the operations of the company's software programming team
- Coordinated communications between multiple departments

EDUCATION HISTORY

BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN COMPUTER SCIENCE
Institution: De Loureigh University
Year of Graduation: 2021

- Founder, DLU Coding Club
- Champion, Beechtown Hackathon 2020

VOLUNTEER WORK AND AFFILIATIONS

- **Volunteer Math Teacher,** Lily River Children's Foundation
- **Member,** Coding Masters Club, Roseton Chapter

RELEVANT SKILLS

- Javascript, C/C++, Java, Python, Kotlin, Go

Before: the original CV

Keith Shannons

Software Engineer

Software engineer with 3+ years of experience building cloud-based business applications with JavaScript, Python and Java. I turn client requirements into reliable software and look for ways to remove manual work, like an HR system that made HR processes 80% faster. Looking for a software engineer role where I can own features from design to deployment.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Junior Software Engineer Mar 2022 – Aug 2025
Heiman Software Labs · global software services company

- Cut the time of HR processes by **80%** by building a cloud-based information system that brings employee data from 5 databases and servers into one place.
- Kept customer satisfaction above **95%** across 12 client projects by designing and building software from each client's requirements.
- Increased the team's delivery speed by **25%** by leading code reviews and setting the technical direction for 3 business applications in development.

Software Engineering Intern Oct 2021 – Dec 2021
Heiman Software Labs

- Built and tested 4 features for an internal tool with the programming team, using Git, pull requests and code reviews.
- Coordinated updates between 3 departments with a weekly status report, so requests stopped getting lost in email.

EDUCATION

BSc in Computer Science Graduated 2021
De Loureigh University

- Founded the DLU Coding Club, which grew to 40 members.
- Champion, Beechtown Hackathon 2020.

CONTACT

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keith.shannons@reallygreatsite.com

PHONE
+123-456-7890

LINKEDIN
linkedin.com/in/keith-shannons

PORTFOLIO
www.reallygreatsite.com

LOCATION
Roseton · open to remote

SKILLS

Languages
JavaScript, Python, Java, Go, Kotlin, C/C++

Frameworks
Node.js, Express, React, Spring Boot

Data & cloud
SQL (PostgreSQL), MongoDB, AWS, Docker

Ways of working
Git, REST APIs, code reviews, Agile/Scrum

Soft skills
Clear communication across teams, mentoring, problem solving

VOLUNTEERING

- **Volunteer Math Teacher**, Lily River Children's Foundation
- **Member**, Coding Masters Club, Roseton Chapter

LANGUAGES

English (fluent)

After: my corrected version